AURELIUS DIGITAL SYSTEMS PVT. LTD.

CODE OF CONDUCT & BUSINESS ETHICS

ETH-COC-01 | Version 5.1

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Department	Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture
Applicability	All employees and, where stated, interns, contractors, consultants, temporary staff, and vendor personnel
Status	APPROVED - CONTROLLED INTERNAL DOCUMENT

Fictional enterprise notice: Aurelius Digital Systems Pvt. Ltd., its identities, systems and internal rules in this document are fictional.

Document Control

ETH-COC-01-DC01 - Document-Control Record

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Controlled repository	VaultPoint DMS
Distribution	Authorized workforce and functions according to classification and applicability
External-law treatment	Where a decision depends on external law or a client obligation not contained here, obtain verified guidance from Legal & Corporate Affairs.

Revision History

ETH-COC-01-RH01 - Revision History

Version	Effective / status	Meaningful change
3.1	Prior controlled release	Initial controlled issue and consolidation of predecessor guidance.
3.6	Prior controlled release	Expanded scope, roles and source-of-truth controls.
4.1	Prior controlled release	Aligned enterprise systems, approval vocabulary and document interfaces.
4.5	Prior controlled release	Added clearer exception, recordkeeping and manager/accountability rules.
4.8	Prior controlled release	Refreshed operational workflows, conditional rules and cross-document handoffs.
5.1	2026-04-01	Current release aligned to enterprise governance baseline and approved process design.

Precedence: This document controls only within its approved subject. Specialist policies, standards and procedures control detailed requirements in their own subject matter; unresolved conflicts are escalated to the relevant Policy Owners.

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Document Governance and Use

Set enterprise expectations for integrity, conflicts, respectful conduct, confidentiality, records, speak-up, investigations and responsible AI behaviour, while delegating detailed operational controls to specialist policies.

Integrity, conflicts, gifts/hospitality, anti-bribery internal standard, confidential information, workplace behaviour, discrimination/harassment, social media, outside employment, political activity, IP, records, client/vendor conduct, whistleblowing, retaliation, investigations, discipline, AI ethics.

Audience: All employees and, where stated, interns, contractors, consultants, temporary staff and vendor personnel.

Controlled-source rule: Convenience copies, email extracts, screenshots and local notes do not supersede the controlled document or authoritative enterprise system for the relevant fact.

ETH-COC-01-DG01 - Document Dependencies

Dependency type	Documents
Primary	
Control	

1 Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 1 Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

1.1 Purpose

Purpose is governed as part of Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For purpose, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

1.2 Who the Code applies to

Who the Code applies to is governed as part of Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For applies, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

1.3 Manager responsibilities

Manager responsibilities is governed as part of Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For manager, responsibilities, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

1.4 Seeking advice

Seeking advice is governed as part of Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For seeking, advice, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

1.5 Relationship to specialist policies

Relationship to specialist policies is governed as part of Purpose, Applicability and Code Expectations. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For relationship, specialist, policies, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

2 Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 2 Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

2.1 Acting honestly

Acting honestly is governed as part of Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For acting, honestly, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T01 - Ethical Decision Escalation Guide

Situation	Primary approver	Specialist concurrence	Evidence
Routine request	Line Manager / designated owner	As triggered	Business purpose + workflow record
Material or high-risk request	Functional Head / Business Owner	Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance as applicable	Risk and exception rationale
Enterprise exception	Executive Approver or governance committee	Policy Owner	Scope, conditions, expiry, review date

2.2 Avoiding misrepresentation

Avoiding misrepresentation is governed as part of Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For avoiding, misrepresentation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S01: Employee is offered a costly gift by a vendor during an active bid. Disclose the item, pause participation in any affected decision if independence could reasonably be questioned, and obtain Ethics/Legal guidance. During active sourcing, gifts that could influence or appear to influence the decision are not accepted.

2.3 Duty to raise concerns

Duty to raise concerns is governed as part of Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For raise, concerns, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

2.4 Ethical decision questions

Ethical decision questions is governed as part of Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For ethical, decision, questions, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

2.5 Escalation

Escalation is governed as part of Integrity and Ethical Decision-Making. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For escalation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

3 Conflicts of Interest

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 3 Conflicts of Interest | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Conflicts of Interest establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

3.1 Personal and financial interests

Personal and financial interests is governed as part of Conflicts of Interest. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For personal, financial, interests, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T02 - Conflict Disclosure and Recusal Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

3.2 Family and close relationships

Family and close relationships is governed as part of Conflicts of Interest. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For family, close, relationships, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

3.3 Vendor/client conflicts

Vendor/client conflicts is governed as part of Conflicts of Interest. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For vendor, client, conflicts, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S02: Manager’s sibling works for a supplier being evaluated. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

3.4 Disclosure and management

Disclosure and management is governed as part of Conflicts of Interest. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For disclosure, management, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

3.5 Recusal and approval

Recusal and approval is governed as part of Conflicts of Interest. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For recusal, approval, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

4 Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 4 Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

4.1 Acceptable low-risk courtesies

Acceptable low-risk courtesies is governed as part of Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For acceptable, courtesies, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T03 - Gift/Hospitality Decision Matrix

Situation	Primary approver	Specialist concurrence	Evidence
Routine request	Line Manager / designated owner	As triggered	Business purpose + workflow record
Material or high-risk request	Functional Head / Business Owner	Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance as applicable	Risk and exception rationale
Enterprise exception	Executive Approver or governance committee	Policy Owner	Scope, conditions, expiry, review date

4.2 Restricted/prohibited situations

Restricted/prohibited situations is governed as part of Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For restricted, prohibited, situations, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

4.3 Pre-approval

Pre-approval is governed as part of Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For approval, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

4.4 Recording gifts/hospitality

A nominal business gift up to INR 3,000 equivalent may be accepted when it is infrequent, lawful, transparent and unrelated to a pending decision. Gifts above INR 3,000 must be disclosed to ethics@aureliusdigital.example before acceptance where practicable. Gifts above INR 10,000 are normally declined or surrendered unless the General Counsel approves a ceremonial exception. Gifts or hospitality are prohibited during an active sourcing decision when they could create perceived influence.

Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For recording, gifts, hospitality, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S03: Consultant posts a screenshot of a client dashboard on social media. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

4.5 Vendor sourcing periods

Vendor sourcing periods is governed as part of Gifts, Hospitality and Business Courtesies. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For vendor, sourcing, periods, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

5 Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 5 Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

5.1 Prohibited improper influence

No worker may offer, authorize, request or accept anything of value intended to improperly influence a decision or obtain an unfair advantage. Payments described as facilitation, speed, goodwill or relationship support are not exempt from this rule. Suspected improper influence must be reported promptly to ethics@aureliusdigital.example or Legal & Corporate Affairs.

Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For prohibited, improper, influence, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

5.2 Facilitation-style requests

Facilitation-style requests is governed as part of Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For facilitation, style, requests, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

5.3 Use of agents/intermediaries

Use of agents/intermediaries is governed as part of Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For agents, intermediaries, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

5.4 Red flags

Red flags is governed as part of Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For flags, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

5.5 Escalation to Legal/Ethics

Escalation to Legal/Ethics is governed as part of Anti-Bribery and Improper Influence Internal Standard. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For escalation, legal, ethics, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S04: Employee reports repeated humiliating comments by a project lead. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

6 Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 6 Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

6.1 Duty of confidentiality

Duty of confidentiality is governed as part of Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidentiality, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

6.2 Client and company information

Client and company information is governed as part of Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For client, company, information, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

6.3 Personal Data

Personal Data is governed as part of Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For personal, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Related controlled source: Data Privacy & Data Governance Policy (PRIV-DG-02) §4 - Personal-data governance. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

6.4 Post-employment duties

Post-employment duties is governed as part of Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For employment, duties, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

6.5 Specialist handling rules

Specialist handling rules is governed as part of Confidential Information, Privacy and Need-to-Know. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For specialist, handling, rules, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Related controlled source: Information Security Policy & Procedures Manual (SEC-POL-01) §3 - Detailed confidential information handling. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

7 Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 7 Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

7.1 Respectful conduct

Respectful conduct is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For respectful, conduct, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T04 - Respectful Workplace Concern Routing

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record
Operational scenario S05: Manager asks an employee not to report a potential ethics issue. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.		

7.2 Bullying and intimidation

Bullying and intimidation is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For bullying, intimidation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

7.3 Discrimination concerns

Discrimination concerns is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For discrimination, concerns, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

7.4 Harassment and sexual harassment concerns

Harassment and sexual harassment concerns is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For harassment, sexual, harassment, concerns, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

7.5 Manager response

Manager response is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For manager, response, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

7.6 Client-site conduct

Client-site conduct is governed as part of Respectful Workplace, Inclusion and Professional Behaviour. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For client, conduct, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

8 Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 8 Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

8.1 Personal social media

Workers speaking personally must not imply they represent Aurelius. Confidential client/company information, internal disputes, security details and non-public commercial information may not be posted. Only authorized spokespersons may make official company statements.

Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For personal, social, media, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

8.2 Speaking on behalf of Aurelius

Speaking on behalf of Aurelius is governed as part of Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For speaking, behalf, aurelius, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S06: Employee wants a second job with a technology competitor. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

8.3 Confidentiality online

Confidentiality online is governed as part of Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidentiality, online, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

8.4 Media/public inquiries

Media/public inquiries is governed as part of Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For media, public, inquiries, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

8.5 Professional profiles

Professional profiles is governed as part of Social Media, Public Statements and External Communications. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For professional, profiles, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

9 Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 9 Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

9.1 Disclosure triggers

Disclosure triggers is governed as part of Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For disclosure, triggers, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T05 - Outside Activity Review Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

9.2 Conflict assessment

Conflict assessment is governed as part of Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For conflict, assessment, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

9.3 Use of company resources

Use of company resources is governed as part of Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For company, resources, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S07: Engineer wants to publish open-source code derived from an internal project. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

9.4 Competing activity

Competing activity is governed as part of Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For competing, activity, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

9.5 Approval and review

Approval and review is governed as part of Outside Employment, Personal Ventures and Board/Advisory Roles. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For approval, review, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

10 Political and Civic Activity

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 10 Political and Civic Activity | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Political and Civic Activity establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

10.1 Personal political activity

Personal political activity is governed as part of Political and Civic Activity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For personal, political, activity, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

10.2 No implied company endorsement

No implied company endorsement is governed as part of Political and Civic Activity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For implied, company, endorsement, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

10.3 Use of company resources

Use of company resources is governed as part of Political and Civic Activity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For company, resources, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

10.4 Workplace disruption

Workplace disruption is governed as part of Political and Civic Activity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For workplace, disruption, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

10.5 External legal compliance left to verified guidance

External legal compliance left to verified guidance is governed as part of Political and Civic Activity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For external, legal, compliance, verified, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S08: Employee edits an expense receipt to make it reimbursable. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

11 Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 11 Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

11.1 Company work product

Company work product is governed as part of Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For company, product, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

11.2 Third-party IP

Third-party IP is governed as part of Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For third, party, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

11.3 Open-source contributions

Open-source contributions is governed as part of Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For source, contributions, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

11.4 External publication

External publication is governed as part of Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For external, publication, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

11.5 Confidential inventions and research

Confidential inventions and research is governed as part of Intellectual Property, Open Source and Company Work Product. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidential, inventions, research, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

12 Accurate Records and Financial Integrity

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 12 Accurate Records and Financial Integrity | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Accurate Records and Financial Integrity establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

12.1 Business records

Business records is governed as part of Accurate Records and Financial Integrity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For business, records, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T06 - Record Integrity Examples

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record
Operational scenario S09: Vendor personnel offers a personal payment to speed an approval. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.		

12.2 Expense records

Expense records is governed as part of Accurate Records and Financial Integrity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For expense, records, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Related controlled source: Travel, Expense & Corporate Card Policy (FIN-EXP-12) §13 - Expense evidence integrity. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

12.3 Time and attendance records

Time and attendance records is governed as part of Accurate Records and Financial Integrity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For attendance, records, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

12.4 Approval integrity

Approval integrity is governed as part of Accurate Records and Financial Integrity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For approval, integrity, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

12.5 Destruction or concealment of records

Destruction or concealment of records is governed as part of Accurate Records and Financial Integrity. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For destruction, concealment, records, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

13 Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 13 Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

13.1 Fair dealing

Fair dealing is governed as part of Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For dealing, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

13.2 Procurement integrity

Procurement integrity is governed as part of Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For procurement, integrity, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Related controlled source: Procurement, Vendor & Third-Party Risk Management Policy (PROC-TPRM-11) §6 - Procurement integrity and conflicts. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

Operational scenario S10: Employee uses a public LLM to draft client material containing confidential data. Stop further submission, preserve the relevant details, notify the Security Operations Centre and Privacy where personal/client data may be involved, and follow AI-GOV-05 for use-case/tool review. Do not attempt to erase evidence by altering logs or accounts.

13.3 Vendor personnel conduct

Vendor personnel conduct is governed as part of Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For vendor, personnel, conduct, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

13.4 Client instructions versus company standards

Client instructions versus company standards is governed as part of Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For client, instructions, versus, company, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

13.5 Third-party misconduct reporting

Third-party misconduct reporting is governed as part of Client, Vendor and Third-Party Conduct. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For third, party, misconduct, reporting, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

14 Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 14 Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

14.1 What to report

What to report is governed as part of Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For report, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T07 - Speak-Up Channel Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

14.2 Available channels

Available channels is governed as part of Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For available, channels, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

14.3 Confidentiality expectations

Confidentiality expectations is governed as part of Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidentiality, expectations, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S11: AI-generated code includes an unknown license notice. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

14.4 Non-retaliation

Non-retaliation is governed as part of Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For retaliation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

14.5 Bad-faith or knowingly false reports

Bad-faith or knowingly false reports is governed as part of Speak-Up Channels and Non-Retaliation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For faith, knowingly, false, reports, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

15 Investigations and Cooperation

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 15 Investigations and Cooperation | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Investigations and Cooperation establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

15.1 Triage and case ownership

Triage and case ownership is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For triage, ownership, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

15.2 Evidence preservation

Evidence preservation is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For evidence, preservation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T08 - Investigation Role and Independence Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

15.3 Cooperation duty

Cooperation duty is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For cooperation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

15.4 Confidentiality

Confidentiality is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidentiality, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

15.5 Conflict and independence

Conflict and independence is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For conflict, independence, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S12: Employee believes a poor performance rating is retaliation for a good-faith report. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

15.6 Referral to specialist investigations

Referral to specialist investigations is governed as part of Investigations and Cooperation. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For referral, specialist, investigations, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

16 Discipline and Corrective Outcomes

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 16 Discipline and Corrective Outcomes | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Discipline and Corrective Outcomes establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

16.1 Principles

Principles is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Outcomes. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For principles, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

16.2 Factors considered

Factors considered is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Outcomes. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For factors, considered, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

16.3 Performance versus misconduct

Performance versus misconduct is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Outcomes. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For performance, versus, misconduct, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

16.4 Manager authority limits

Manager authority limits is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Outcomes. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For manager, authority, limits, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

16.5 Separation handoff

Separation handoff is governed as part of Discipline and Corrective Outcomes. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For separation, handoff, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S13: Investigator has a personal relationship with the subject of the investigation. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

17 AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 17 AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

17.1 Human accountability

Human accountability is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For human, accountability, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

17.2 Truthfulness and disclosure

Truthfulness and disclosure is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For truthfulness, disclosure, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

ETH-COC-01-T09 - Responsible AI Conduct Matrix

Control point	Required treatment	Evidence
Business purpose	Must be defined before action or approval	Request/workflow record
Independent approval	No self-approval where requester benefits or is conflicted	Approval history
Specialist trigger	Route Security/Privacy/Legal/Finance/HR review when criteria apply	Concurrence record
Exception	Document scope, justification, controls and expiry	Approved exception record

17.3 Bias/fairness concerns

Bias/fairness concerns is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For fairness, concerns, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

17.4 Confidentiality in prompts

Confidentiality in prompts is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For confidentiality, prompts, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

17.5 AI-generated code/content

AI-generated code/content is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For generated, content, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

17.6 Client-facing AI

Client-facing AI is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For client, facing, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

17.7 AI governance handoff

AI governance handoff is governed as part of AI Ethics and Responsible Generative AI Use. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For governance, handoff, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Related controlled source: AI, Machine Learning & Generative AI Governance Standard (AI-GOV-05) §4 - Operational AI governance handoff. This reference supplements this section and does not transfer ownership of unrelated rules.

18 Advice, Exceptions and Governance

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section 18 Advice, Exceptions and Governance | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

Advice, Exceptions and Governance establishes the requirements, responsibilities and decision rules that apply within this part of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics. The rules are interpreted with the document scope, the employee/worker or system context, and any specialist cross-reference that applies.

18.1 No exception to integrity core

No exception to integrity core is governed as part of Advice, Exceptions and Governance. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For exception, integrity, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

18.2 Manageable conflicts and documented approvals

Manageable conflicts and documented approvals is governed as part of Advice, Exceptions and Governance. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For manageable, conflicts, documented, approvals, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Operational scenario S14: Client asks team to do something that appears inconsistent with company conduct rules. Apply the requirements in Code of Conduct & Business Ethics to the facts, confirm the relevant source-of-truth record and route any specialist issue to the controlling document or function. If a required fact is missing, do not invent it; obtain the controlled record or specialist decision.

18.3 Ethics advice

Ethics advice is governed as part of Advice, Exceptions and Governance. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For ethics, advice, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

18.4 EREC escalation

EREC escalation is governed as part of Advice, Exceptions and Governance. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For escalation, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

18.5 Code review and training

Code review and training is governed as part of Advice, Exceptions and Governance. Workers are expected to act with integrity even when a proposed action is not expressly listed in this Code.

For review, training, appearance matters as well as intent: a reasonable observer should be able to understand the business purpose and why the decision was independent. When personal interest, pressure, secrecy or an unusual benefit could affect judgment, the worker must disclose the situation and seek independent guidance before proceeding.

- Disclose material conflicts before participating in the affected decision.
- Do not conceal, mislabel or destroy records relevant to an ethics concern or investigation.
- Seek guidance early when the correct course is unclear; uncertainty is not a reason to proceed secretly.

Appendices, Forms and Checklists

Code of Conduct & Business Ethics | ETH-COC-01 | v5.1 | Effective 2026-04-01 | Section Appendices Controlled execution aids | Legal & Corporate Affairs / People & Culture | INTERNAL

ETH-COC-01-AA Code Definitions

Term	Controlled meaning
Worker	Umbrella term covering employees and non-employee workers with an Aurelius work relationship or approved access.
Employee	Worker in RFT, RPT, or FXT category. Interns, apprentices, contractors, consultants, temporary staff, and vendor personnel are not called Employees unless a specific engagement record explicitly says otherwise.
Non-Employee Worker	Worker in INT, APP, CTR, CNS, TMP, or VND category for registry purposes.
People Manager	Manager with formal direct reports in PeopleHub. A project lead is not automatically a People Manager.
Line Manager	The PeopleHub-recorded manager responsible for routine people approvals and supervision.
Functional Head	Band 7 or Band 8 leader accountable for a major department or function.
Business Owner	Named role accountable for business purpose, outcomes, funding, and risk decisions for a service, vendor, model, process, or system.
System Owner	Named role accountable for a system's lifecycle, business operation, access model, and control implementation.
Data Owner	Named business role accountable for a data domain's classification, authorized use, access conditions, and lifecycle decisions.
Asset Custodian	Person or team assigned operational possession or administration of an information or technology asset; custody does not transfer ownership accountability.
Policy Owner	Senior role accountable for policy interpretation, maintenance, exceptions, and review.
Control Owner	Role accountable for design and operating effectiveness of a defined control.

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-AB Ethical Decision Checklist

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-AC Conflict Disclosure Checklist

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-AD Speak-Up and Escalation Guide

Contact	Purpose
legal@aureliusdigital.example	General Legal & Corporate Affairs matters
ethics@aureliusdigital.example	Ethics concerns, conflicts, and Code of Conduct questions

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-AE Investigation Intake Triage Guide

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-F01 Conflict of Interest Disclosure

Field	Entry / controlled record
Requester / worker name	
Employee or worker ID	
Department / project	
Manager / sponsor	
Date / effective period	
Business purpose	
Requested action or decision	
Supporting evidence	
Approvals / concurrence	
Exception or risk notes	
Closure / outcome	
Record location	

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-F02 Gift/Hospitality Declaration

Field	Entry / controlled record
Requester / worker name	
Employee or worker ID	
Department / project	
Manager / sponsor	
Date / effective period	
Business purpose	
Requested action or decision	
Supporting evidence	
Approvals / concurrence	
Exception or risk notes	
Closure / outcome	
Record location	

Appendices - continued

ETH-COC-01-F03 Outside Activity Disclosure

Use this checklist as an execution aid. It does not create an exception or replace an approval required by the controlling section.

- Confirm the request or event is within the scope of Code of Conduct & Business Ethics.
- Verify the authoritative worker, system, vendor, expense, incident or model record before taking action.
- Identify conditions that change the rule, including employment category, band, data classification, risk level, location, client assignment or service criticality.
- Obtain independent approval and specialist concurrence where the policy requires it.
- Record the decision, evidence, exception conditions and any expiry or follow-up date in the designated system.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts to the Policy Owner rather than creating a local workaround.